Read Words in Context

Vocabulary Words

annual	**luminous**
billowy	**perilous**
breathtaking	**sincere**
convenient	**spectacular**
dense	**spotless**
distant	**unique**
ebony	**wondrous**
genuine	

Word Learning Tip!

An **adjective** describes a noun or a pronoun. It usually comes before a noun or after a linking verb. You can use an adjective's placement in a sentence as a clue to its meaning. Adjectives can compare or they can tell *what kind, which one, how many,* or *how much.*

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues Often you can find the meaning of an unfamiliar adjective by using the word's context—the surrounding words and phrases. These clues help you determine what a new adjective means.

READ!

A Family Tradition

Amber and her family take an **annual** vacation. Every year they either go on a long trip to some **distant** place or stay close to home. "Let's go to Bryant Park and camp this year," Amber's father said. "It's **convenient** and comfortable, and I don't want to drive a long way this year. "

Amber likes Bryant Park because of its **breathtaking** scenery. One beautiful sight that excites her is the **spectacular** waterfall with its **perilous** drop of five hundred feet. Although Amber's admiration for the beauty of the falls is **sincere** and honest, she has to admit that the steepness of the drop also frightens her.

Amber and her sisters love to hike in the **dense** forests where the pine trees are packed thickly together. When they reach a clearing, they watch the **billowy** clouds sweep over their heads like waves on the ocean. At night, the **luminous** stars shine brightly against the **ebony** sky, like jewels laid out on a cloth of black velvet.

The campground is always **spotless**, too. People pick up their litter and carefully place it in trash cans. "This is a **wondrous** place," Amber says. "It fills you with **genuine** wonder about all of nature. The beauty of the place is so real and intense."

"Yes," her mother agrees. "Bryant Park is a rare treasure and a **unique** one. If old growth forests like this were destroyed, they could never be replaced!"



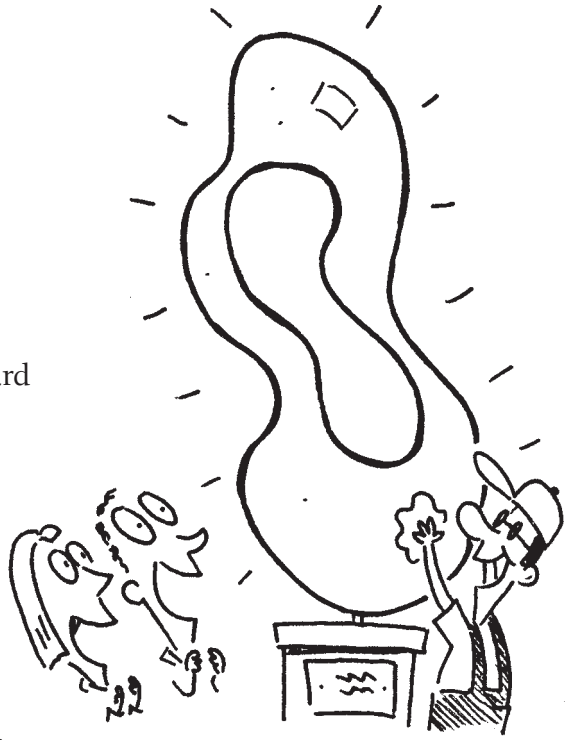
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Connect Words and Meanings

annual	**convenient**	**ebony**	**perilous**	**spotless**
billowy	**dense**	**genuine**	**sincere**	**unique**
breathtaking	**distant**	**luminous**	**spectacular**	**wondrous**

Directions Match each adjective with its definition. Write the number of the correct adjective on the left in the space before the definition on the right.

	Adjective		Definition
1.	spotless	_____	**A.** exciting; thrilling; very beautiful; takes your breath away
2.	unique	_____	**B.** real, not fake; honest
3.	breathtaking	_____	**C.** far away
4.	convenient	_____	**D.** dangerous
5.	dense	_____	**E.** one of a kind
6.	distant	_____	**F.** deep black; made of a hard black wood
7.	ebony	_____	**G.** thick; crowded
8.	genuine	_____	**H.** perfectly clean
9.	wondrous	_____	**I.** marvelous; fills you with wonder and amazement
10.	perilous	_____	**J.** easy to reach or use; useful



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Connect More Words and Meanings

annual	convenient	ebony	perilous	spotless
billowy	dense	genuine	sincere	unique
breathtaking	distant	luminous	spectacular	wondrous

Directions First, read each definition. Then choose the word that best fits in the blank. Write it on the line.

11. **Definition:** yearly
We took our _____ trip to the lake in August.

12. **Definition:** shining; glowing in the dark
The moon cast a _____ light on the lake.

13. **Definition:** remarkable; dramatic; exciting
Watching the falling stars was a _____ experience.

14. **Definition:** swelling as in waves
The fluffy clouds looked _____ against the night sky.

15. **Definition:** honest; truthful; heart-felt
I gave my _____ thanks to my parents for taking me on this vacation.

16. **Definition:** so wonderful it takes your breath away
Watching the skiers holding torches while skiing down the mountain at midnight was a _____ experience.

17. **Definition:** far away or removed
We could see snow on the tops of the _____ mountains.

18. **Definition:** real or true
The jeweler said that the diamond the hikers found was _____, not a fake.

Make a Vacation Brochure Work with a small group to choose a place you would like to visit. Then make a brochure by folding a piece of paper in half. On the cover, write the name of your dream spot and a phrase to describe it. Inside, write about your place, using as many vocabulary words as you can.

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Use Words in Context

annual	convenient	ebony	perilous	spotless
billowy	dense	genuine	sincere	unique
breathtaking	distant	luminous	spectacular	wondrous

Directions Each item below asks you to name two things. First, determine what each adjective in boldface means. Look for a clue in the sentence. Then write your answers in the blanks.

Name two **convenient** household items that make people's lives easier.

1. _____ **2.** _____

Name two activities that could be **perilous** or very risky.

3. _____ **4.** _____

Name two things that are so **dense** you can get lost in them.

5. _____ **6.** _____

Name two **distant** places that are hard to reach.

7. _____ **8.** _____

Name two things that could be **unique** or one-of-a-kind.

9. _____ **10.** _____

Name two things that are real and **genuine** instead of fake.

11. _____ **12.** _____

Name two **sincere** people whom you know and trust.

13. _____ **14.** _____

Name two natural events you think are **wondrous**.

15. _____ **16.** _____



Describe a Family Tradition Fold a sheet of paper in half. On the left, name one of your family traditions that you like a lot. On the right, describe why you enjoy this tradition. Use three vocabulary words. Try to use at least two new adjectives also.

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Put Words Into Action

annual	convenient	ebony	perilous	spotless
billowy	dense	genuine	sincere	unique
breathtaking	distant	luminous	spectacular	wondrous

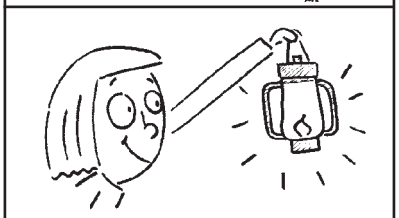
Directions Look at each picture. Then read the definition. Write the vocabulary word that matches each definition in the blank on the right. Then write a sentence about the picture using the vocabulary word.



Definition: yearly

1. **Word:** _____
2. **Sentence:** _____

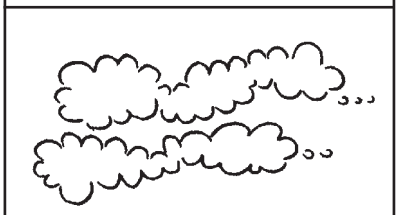
_____



Definition: shining bright; glowing in the dark

3. **Word:** _____
4. **Sentence:** _____

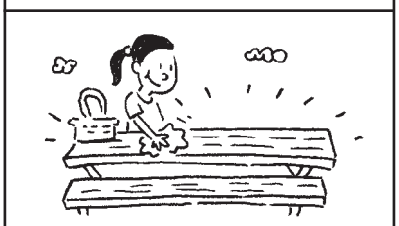
_____



Definition: wavelike

5. **Word:** _____
6. **Sentence:** _____

_____



Definition: perfectly clean

7. **Word:** _____
8. **Sentence:** _____

_____



Definition: black; very dark

9. **Word:** _____
10. **Sentence:** _____

_____

Write an E-Mail Imagine you are a member of the Chung family. Write an e-mail to a family member who could not make it to the picnic. Use at least three vocabulary words to describe the reunion. Try to use two new adjectives, too.

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Review and Extend

annual	**convenient**	**ebony**	**perilous**	**spotless**
billowy	**dense**	**genuine**	**sincere**	**unique**
breathtaking	**distant**	**luminous**	**spectacular**	**wondrous**

Learn More!

Adjectives can be used to show comparison. Add *-er* and *-est* to adjectives that have only one syllable. Use *more* and *most* with longer adjectives.

Describe One	Compare Two	Compare More Than Two
dense	denser	densest
breathtaking	more breathtaking	most breathtaking
luminous	more luminous	most luminous

Directions Choose the correct form of the adjective from the two choices in parentheses. Write the correct form in the blank. Use the context to determine if you are comparing two or more than two.

1. This year's party decorations are _____ (*more spectacular, most spectacular*) than last year's.
2. Richmond Beach is the _____ (*more convenient, most convenient*) place for the whole family to meet.
3. Words spoken from the heart are _____ (*more sincere, most sincere*) than anything taken from a book.
4. Her smile lit up the room. It was the _____ (*more luminous, most luminous*) smile I had ever seen.
5. The recipe with butter makes a _____ (*denser, densest*) cake than the one without butter.
6. What could be _____ (*more wondrous, most wondrous*) than a double rainbow?

Write a Comparison Write a diary entry in which you compare two or more things your family has done together in the past few years. You might compare family vacations, parties, or visits to relatives. Use at least three vocabulary words to make comparisons.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Circle the letter of the item the best completes each sentence below.

1. If a store is **convenient**, it might—
A. be near your home **B.** not have the things you need **C.** be so large you can't find the things you need

2. A **wondrous** sight might be—
A. a pile of litter on the street **B.** the sun setting over the ocean **C.** a gloomy day

3. An **ebony** statue would be—
A. made of dark wood **B.** made of silver metal **C.** made of clear plastic

4. An **annual** event could be—
A. a weekly test **B.** dinner at home **C.** an anniversary

5. Clouds that are **billowy** might be—
A. dark and gloomy **B.** curvy and fluffy **C.** hard to see

Directions On the lines below, write the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence.

6. If you have a one-of-a-kind object, it is a(n) _____ (*unique, ebony, luminous*) possession.

7. If you scrub the floor thoroughly, it will turn out _____ (*breathtaking, convenient, spotless*).

8. During the Civil War, people lived through _____ (*ebony, perilous, spotless*) times.

9. An experienced jeweler can tell a _____ (*distant, convenient, genuine*) diamond from a fake one.

10. A person who is _____ (*sincere, spectacular, wondrous*) can be trusted to tell the truth.

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